SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "BOURGUEIL"

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Bourgueil", initially recognised by the decree of 31 July 1937.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the geographical denomination "Val de Loire" according to the rules fixed in the present specification for the use of this geographical denomination.

III. – Types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Bourgueil" is reserved for still red and rosé wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines take place in the geographical area approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee on the date of 16 December 2010. The perimeter of this area, at the date of approval of the present specification by the competent national committee, encompasses the territory of the following communes of the Indre-et-Loire department on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2018:

Benais, Bourgueil, La Chapelle-sur-Loire, Chouzé-sur-Loire, Coteaux de Loire for the sole territory of the delegated communes of Saint-Patrice and Ingrandes-de-Touraine, Restigné, Saint-Nicolas-de-Bourgueil.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 7 and 8 November 1995.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

Indre-et-Loire department: Avoine, Azay-le-Rideau, Beaumont-en-Véron, Candes-Saint-Martin, Cheillé, Chinon, Cinais, Gizeux, Huismes, Lerné, Lignières-de-Touraine, Marcay, Rigny-Ussé, Rivarennes, Rivière, La Roche-Clermault, Saché, Saint-Benoît-la-Forêt, Saint-Germain-sur-Vienne, Savigny-en-Véron, Seuilly, Thizay, Vallères

Maine-et-Loire department: Allonnes, Brain-sur-Allonnes, Varennes-sur-Loire, Villebernier. Procédure nationale d'opposition suite à l'avis du Comité national des appellations d'origine relatives aux vins et aux boissons alcoolisées, et des boissons spiritueuses du 6 septembre 2018 3

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The wines come from the following varieties: - main variety: cabernet franc N; - accessory variety: cabernet-sauvignon N.

b) – Plantings and replantings carried out with the following clones of the cabernet franc N variety are prohibited: 210, 211 and 212.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

The proportion of the cabernet-sauvignon N variety is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training method

a) – Planting density.
The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,500 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows of 2.10 metres maximum. The spacing between plants within the same row may not be less than 0.80 metre and greater than 1.10 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.
The vines are pruned, before 1 May, with a maximum of 12 free eyes (buds) per plant, according to the following techniques: - single Guyot pruning, with a long cane bearing a maximum of 8 free eyes and a maximum of 2 spurs pruned to 1 or 2 free eyes; - pruning with 2 half-canes bearing a maximum of 4 free eyes each and a maximum of 2 spurs pruned to 1 or 2 free eyes; - spur pruning (trained in Royat cordon) with a maximum of 6 spurs or "poussiers" pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.
- The vines are compulsorily trained in the "raised single-plane trellising" mode. The height of the trellised foliage must be at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire. - The lower trellising wire is at a maximum of 0.55 metre above the ground.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
The average maximum load is fixed, per parcel, at 8,500 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Thresholds for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Overall cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of the soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

a) – a plant cover of the headlands is compulsory at a minimum of 1 metre from the anchoring point of the trellising of the vine, and this distance is brought to 2.50 metres when the soil is maintained mechanically;

b) – On at least 40 % of the area comprised between 2 rows, either a soil tillage is carried out or a plant cover, sown or spontaneous, is present, and, in the latter case, the control of the spontaneous vegetation is carried out mechanically.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes. Grapes presenting a sugar content lower than the following may not be considered as being at proper ripeness: - 180 grams per litre of must, for the red wines; - 171 grams per litre of must, for the rosé wines.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 10.5 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 55 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 65 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of the varieties. The wines come from the main variety alone or from a blend of grapes or wines in which the main variety is predominant. The wines may not come from the accessory variety alone.

b) – Malolactic fermentation. The malolactic fermentation is completed for the red wines. The malic acid content is less than or equal to 0.3 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards. After packaging, the wines present the following analytical standards: - the red wines present a content of fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose) less than or equal to 2 grams per litre; - the rosé wines present a content of fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose) less than or equal to 4 grams per litre and a total acidity content, expressed in grams of tartaric acid per litre, greater than 3.5 grams per litre.

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments. - For the elaboration of the rosé wines, the use of charcoals for oenological use, alone or in a mixture in preparations, is prohibited. - The subtractive enrichment techniques are authorised for the red wines and the maximum rate of partial concentration in relation to the volumes used is fixed at 10 %. - The wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %.

e) – Vat capacity. Every operator demonstrates a vat capacity equivalent at least to 1.5 times the average per-hectare yield vinified on the holding, multiplied by the area in production.

f) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis reports must be kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a specific place for the storage of the packaged products.

4° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer. The wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers. The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on 1 December of the year of harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The vineyard of the controlled designation of origin "Bourgueil" is situated to the north of the Loire, a few kilometres upstream from its confluence with the Vienne, at the north-western extremity of the vineyard of "Touraine". The geographical area is bordered, to the north, by the forest of Gâtine and, to the south, by the Loire. It rests, for one third, on a vast hillside globally oriented to the south and crowned by the forest, and, for the remaining two thirds, on the terraces and the crests, locally called "montilles", present at the foot of the latter. The hillside is cut by the valley of the Changeon, a watercourse whose course is oriented north-south, and which marks the limit between the communes of Bourgueil and Benais.

The soils of the lower part of the hillside are brown calcareous soils developed on the micaceous glauconitic chalk of the Turonian, or the yellow tuffeau chalk, whereas at mid-hillside have developed clayey-siliceous soils, arising from the clayey-sandy formations of the Senonian. At the foot of the hillside, the soils developed on the terraces of ancient alluvium and on the "montilles" — small crests arising from the modern alluvium in the major bed of the river — are free-draining, sandy-gravelly, more or less stony.

The geographical area covers 8 communes of the Indre-et-Loire department. It benefits from a climate appreciably milder and drier than that of the whole of the Touraine region: - the minimum, mean and maximum temperatures there are one degree higher; - the annual precipitation there is about 75 millimetres lower. The densely wooded plateau that crowns the viticultural hillside ensures a protection against the cold winds coming from the North.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

It appears that the origin of the Bourgueil vineyard is linked to the foundation of the abbey of Bourgueil, in 990, which gives us the first written traces. In 1189, the abbot BAUDRY celebrates the charms of his monastery and of its wine. Over the centuries, the vineyard overflows the walls of the enclosure of the abbey and extends over the hillsides and the ancient terraces of the Loire.

Locally called "breton", the cabernet franc N variety is the main variety of the grape varieties of the controlled designation of origin. Very certainly introduced by the river, its establishment in the region could only have been encouraged by the political union of Anjou and Aquitaine (11th and 12th centuries). Benefiting from its situation on the banks of the Loire, the vineyard of the region of Bourgueil is, for a long time, an exporter of fine wines, with a commercial current turned towards the sea, notably towards the Flemish countries from the 17th century.

The vineyard planted on the terraces of ancient alluvium resists phylloxera for a long time, the propagation of which is slower in the sands. Its rapid reconstitution in grafted vines, and with the cabernet franc N variety alone, testifies to the attachment of the winegrowers to the variety that they adopted in the Middle Ages. Since 1937, the date of recognition of the controlled designation of origin "Bourgueil", the volumes produced are increasing. Whereas market gardening and the production of seeds or of liquorice constituted, at the beginning of the 20th century, an important part of the agricultural activity of the Bourgueillois, these crops have disappeared, and the region is essentially turned towards viticulture. In 2009, the vineyard covers 1,400 hectares, exploited by 180 winegrowers, elaborating 73,000 hectolitres. The red wines represent the essential part of the production, with nearly 95 % of the volumes.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The rosé wines most often present aromas of small red and white fruits, fresh and fairly intense, sometimes enhanced by a note of citrus or pepper. The red wines are elegant wines, with a colour that may range from dark ruby to deep garnet. Their tannic structure is often well present but melted. The aromatic expression most often combines notes of red fruits and black fruits. Some wines, more opulent, gain from being kept a few years. They may then reveal more complex notes — cocoa-like, slightly smoky or spicy.

3° – Causal interactions

Reflecting the usages, the delimited parcel area for the harvesting of the grapes retains only the parcels presenting brown soils, or shallow soils on the glauconitic chalk of the Turonian of the hillside, and the sandy-clayey or sandy-gravelly soils of the terraces and “montilles”. These soils present a good water and thermal behaviour. The good openness of the landscape makes it possible to benefit from the particular climatic conditions. These situations offer the cabernet franc N variety conditions particularly favourable to an original and elegant expression, but impose an optimal management of the plant and of its production potential, reflected in the prohibition of certain clones, the training of the vine and a short pruning.

The situations exploited on the sandy-clayey or sandy-gravelly soils are favourable to a fruity aromatic expression in the wines, with fine and supple tannins that explain the success of the wines from the year of harvest. The viticultural situations exploited on the Turonian substratum are conducive to the production of more opulent red wines, having a good tannic structure. The know-how of the elaborators and the fidelity for more than eight centuries to the cabernet franc N variety, acquired from the experience of several generations, are expressed in the choice of the blends of the wines from the different situations. This know-how, adapted to the specific conditions of this territory first dedicated to the production of red wine, has naturally been applied for the production of the rosé wines.

Flowing at the foot of the vineyard, the Loire is intimately linked to the origin and to the history of the Bourgueil vineyard. The river cleared the great hillside by erosion. It also deposited the alluvium that represents the essential part of the substratum on which the vineyard rests. A route of exchange and communication, the Loire played a very active and essential commercial role. The notoriety and the reputation of the wines of “Bourgueil”, whose subtle and fruity perfume is evoked as early as the 11th century in the archives of the Benedictine abbey, continue to prosper thanks to the dynamism of the producers and of its promoters gathered together within associations such as the commanderie of the “Dive Bouteille” or the “Maison des vins”, installed in the birthplace of the actor Jean CARMET.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Delimited parcel area

On a transitional basis, the parcels planted with vine excluded from the delimited parcel area of the controlled designation of origin, identified by their cadastral references, their area and their grape varieties, the list of which was approved by the competent national committee at the sessions of 7 and 8 November 1995, provided that they meet the conditions fixed by the present specification, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2025 harvest inclusive.

2° – Training methods

The vine parcels in place on 31 December 1995, and not respecting the provisions relating to planting density fixed in the present specification, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2025 harvest inclusive, subject to compliance with the trellising and foliage-height rules fixed in the present specification.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The optional terms whose use, by virtue of the Community provisions, may be regulated by the Member States, are entered in characters whose dimensions, in height, width and thickness, are not greater than double those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The dimensions of the characters of the geographical denomination “Val de Loire” are not greater, both in height and in width, than two-thirds of those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

c) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that: - it is a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - and it appears on the harvest declaration.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Prior declaration of parcel allocation

Each operator declares, before 1 February of the year of harvest, to the defence and management body, the list of the parcels allocated to the production of the controlled designation of origin. The declaration is renewable by tacit renewal, except for modifications notified by the operator before 1 February preceding each harvest. This declaration specifies in particular: - the identity of the operator; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the cooperative cellar(s) to which it is, where applicable, a supplier; - for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the year of planting, the variety, the planting density, the spacings on the row and between rows.

2. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, at the latest 72 hours before the harvest, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body transmits this information to the approved control body as soon as possible.

3. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body before 10 December of the year of harvest. It indicates in particular: - the designation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the colour; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the operator; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

4. Prior declaration of transactions

Every operator declares each bulk transaction to the approved control body within time limits fixed in the control or inspection plan, which may not exceed fifteen working days before the operation. This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular: - the name of the appellation and the colour; - the identity of the operator; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the identification of the lot; - the volume of the lot; - the identification of the containers; - the identity of the buyer.

5. Prior declaration of packaging

a) – Every operator packaging a wine of the controlled designation of origin, not demonstrating a certified system of traceability and of sample conservation, makes, to the approved control body, a packaging declaration, at the latest within the 24 hours following the completion of the packaging of the lot(s) of wine; b) – Every operator packaging a wine of the controlled designation of origin, demonstrating a certified system of traceability and of sample conservation, keeps a special register recording each packaging according to the arrangements fixed in the control or inspection plan.

6. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the approved control

body within time limits fixed in the control or inspection plan, which may not exceed fifteen working days before any dispatch.

7. Fallback (repli) declaration

Every operator marketing a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin under a more general appellation makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body at least fifteen days before this fallback.

8. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends to the defence and management body and to the approved control body a downgrading declaration at the latest on the 20th of the month following the day of the downgrading(s) carried out. It indicates in particular: - the name of the appellation and the colour of the product concerned; - the identity of the operator and its EVV or SIRET number; - the volume of wine downgraded; - the balance of volume remaining claimed under the controlled designation of origin for the colour of the product concerned.

II. – Keeping of registers

1. Vinification register

Every operator vinifying wines of the controlled designation of origin keeps up to date a register on which is recorded, per vat: - the date of harvest; - the colour; - the natural alcoholic strength by volume.

2. Vines under transitional provisions

Every operator exploiting vine parcels in place on 31 December 1995, and not respecting the provisions relating to planting density fixed in the present specification, keeps up to date a register on which is indicated, for the parcels concerned: - the cadastral reference; - the area; - the year of planting; - the variety; - the planting density; - the spacings on the row and between the rows.

CHAPTER III

I – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area and monitoring of the transitional measures.	Documentary check (up-to-date CVI record) and check in the field.
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of transitional measures, planting density and trellising).	Documentary check. Up-to-date keeping of the production potential.
A3 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities. — Overall vat capacity.	Check in the field.
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning.	Counting of the number of free eyes per plant and description of the pruning method. Check in the field.
Average maximum load per parcel.	Counting of bunches and estimation of the load from an indicative table drawn up for this purpose (variety, weight, bunches, density). Check in the field.
Other cultivation practices.	Check in the field.
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Natural alcoholic strength by volume.	Documentary check and check in the field. Verification of the records carried out by the operators.
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Monitoring of the vinification.	Documentary check and check in the field. Verification of the records carried out for all the vinification lots by the operators.

Compliance with the date of placing on the market for the consumer.	Documentary check and check in the field.
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Authorised yield.	Documentary check (check of declarations), monitoring of the authorised derogations.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines that are the subject of a transaction between operators.	Analytical and organoleptic examination.
Wines ready to be placed on the market for the consumer (in bulk or packaged).	Analytical and organoleptic examination.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.

II – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL-SOUS-BOIS Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
Fax: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.04
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The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, under the authority of the INAO, on the basis of an approved inspection plan.

The inspection plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.